



Medical centrifuging toy

Stanford bio-engineers have developed a toy that can separate material fluids by manual spinning. <http://dgit.in/SpinMed>



Snapdragon 835 leaks

Qualcomm promises that the new Snapdragon 835 processor will be 27% faster and 40% more power efficient. <http://dgit.in/Sdragon835>

Feature

intended one was already taken. Skype, as it appears, is a straightforward combination of sky and peer-to-peer. They had originally shortened it to Skyper, but since that wasn't available, Skype it was and Skype it is.

Yahoo

This one was initially founded as 'Jerry and David's Guide to the World Wide Web'. A year later the domain Yahoo.com was registered and the company founded. Initial impression would suggest to people that the name is based on the traditional meaning of the word, but Yahoo actually expands to Yet Another Hierarchical Official Oracle. Don't worry, the founders loved the original name too.

Twitter

Another pretty well known one, what with the logo and everything. Initially, Twitter was supposed to be named twttr, inspired by Flickr. Founder Jack Dorsey was always fascinated by how cities communicate in real time and wanted to build an SMS service to communicate with a small group. The initial name that they had decided was Status. "We did a bunch of namestorming, and we came up with the word 'twitch,' because the phone kind of vibrates when it moves. But 'twitch' is not a good product name because it doesn't bring up the right imagery. So we looked in the dictionary for words around it, and we came across the word 'twitter,' and it was just perfect. The definition was 'a short burst of inconsequential information,' and 'chirps from birds.' And that's exactly what the product was," Dorsey told the LA Times in 2009.

eBay

Originally, eBay was known as AuctionWeb. After unexpected growth (as much as 10 times in a year's time) founder Pierre Omidyar wanted to change the name. The company was owned by his consulting firm Echo Bay Technology Group and Omidyar wanted to rename the website to echobay.com. But since that already



Those bots could be carrying a much larger name!

belonged to Echo Bay Mines, a gold mining company, he shortened it to his second choice, eBay.com.

Spotify

This one is pretty interesting. The company was started in Sweden. If you check Google Translate, Spotify doesn't mean anything in Swedish. So what's the name for? The founders of Spotify, Daniel Ek and Martin Lorentzon were busy thinking of names for their new company when one of the names suggested was misheard as Spotify. Well, that sort of stuck to their heads and a quick Google and domain search later, they realised that it was all theirs to claim. They were initially too embarrassed to admit this as the story behind the name, so a little fabrication later, Spotify is also known to have originated from the words Spot and Identify.



An accidental name that just stuck

Ubuntu

According to the official website, "Ubuntu is an ancient African word meaning 'humanity to others'. It also means 'I am what I am because of who we all are'. The Ubuntu operating system brings the spirit of Ubuntu to the world of computers." That is a very noble notion for an open source software and hence it was decided to be the perfect fit.

Instagram

The founders wanted to convey the feeling that one gets from the 'Instant cameras' of the olden days, something that we take for granted today. They also wanted to incorporate the feeling of sending a telegram over the wire, which is what sharing photos on Instagram felt like. Hence (Insta)nt+Tele(gram) = Instagram.

Xerox

Xerox was originally founded as the Haloid Photographic Company, which originally manufactured photographic paper and equipment. It was around 1938 when an independent physicist Chester Carlson invented a process



This is an example of a brand renaming the entire category

to print images using an electrically charged drum and dry powder 'toner'. Haloid's 'founder' saw the promise in his invention and acquired it for commercial production. To differentiate the process, Haloid created the term Xerography which has Greek roots that mean 'dry writing', which eventually led to the name Xerox Corporation in 1961.

Apache

The Apache Software Foundation, that maintains the Apache HTTP server, draws its name in respect to the Native American Apache Nation. Also, the founders got started by applying patches to code written for the NCSA's httpd daemon. The result - 'A PATCHY' server. Yeah, we know.

And more

Explaining names of the likes of Facebook and Microsoft would be an insult to Digit readers. On the other hand, we did really run out of space with this one, so if you have any names and interesting stories behind them, let us know! 